

GOOI-GOOI

Digital Design Specification

Pure Rotating Savings — No Frills, No Hierarchy

iMaliChat Platform • Version 1.2 (Revised)

Revision Summary (v1.0 → v1.2)

The following changes have been incorporated across revisions:

#	Version	Section	Change
1	1.1	Entity 1: Group — total_cycles	total_cycles is now any positive integer, not restricted to member count.
2	1.1	Entity 2: Member — Initiator role	Initiator now has explicit rights: remove members, change contribution amounts (pre-Active), and trigger payouts.
3	1.1	Entity 3: Cycle — cycle count	Cycle description updated: a group may have any number of cycles as set by total_cycles.
4	1.1	Entity 3: Recipient Contribution Rule	Default changed: recipient IS required to contribute in their own cycle.
5	1.1	Flow 1: Group Formation — Invite step	Invitations sent via iMaliChat platform chat message (rich card).
6	1.1	Problem 1: Position Assignment	BIDDING included at launch alongside AGREED and RANDOM.
7	1.1	Problem 2: Custody Question	Rewritten around platform's native trust accounting ledger and escrow system.
8	1.1	Problem 4: Mid-Round Member Changes	Withdrawal penalty decided by group vote (80% threshold) — no fixed percentage.
9	1.1	Transparency: The Enforcement Engine	Replaced with full single-screen dashboard specification (five named zones).
10	1.1	Security Architecture — Authentication	Simplified: platform-level auth covers all requirements.
11	1.1	Authorisation Matrix	Payout trigger and default penalty application moved to Initiator (manual). 72-hour auto-trigger as system fallback.
12	1.1	Cultural Integration	Ndlovukazi mascot reference removed.

13	1.2	Entity 2: Member — delegate_trigger_to	New field: Initiator may delegate trigger rights to another member. Full delegation model added.
14	1.2	Cycle state — AWAITING_TRIGGER	Delegation scope clarified: delegate can trigger payouts only; cannot apply penalties, remove members, or dissolve group.
15	1.2	Authorisation Matrix	TRIGGER DELEGATE role added as a column. Scope of delegation precisely bounded.

Design Philosophy

The gooi-gooi is the most elemental form of collective savings: a group of people who trust each other, pooling money in turns. No officers, no constitution, no hierarchy. This specification digitises that trust — and nothing more.

The Core Discipline

Every design decision must pass one test: does this feature preserve the spirit of the gooi-gooi, or does it turn it into a stokvel?

A stokvel has a chairperson, a treasurer, a constitution, and formal rules. A gooi-gooi has none of these.

The Initiator in this system is a convenor, not a boss — they set up the group and serve as a human check on automated processes, not as a financial authority.

This specification deliberately leaves things out. Restraint is a feature.

Core Data Model

The system models five fundamental entities. Every other concept derives from these five.

Entity 1: The Group

A group is a closed collection of members who have agreed to save together for a defined number of cycles.

Field	Description
group_id	Unique identifier (UUID)
name	Human-readable group name, chosen by members collectively
contribution_amount	Fixed ZAR amount each member contributes per cycle — immutable once Active
cycle_frequency	WEEKLY BIWEEKLY MONTHLY
member_count	Number of members in the group (N)

total_cycles	Total number of cycles for this round. Can be any positive integer — not restricted to N. For example, a 5-member group could run 10 cycles (each member receives twice) or 3 cycles (not every member receives in the round).
status	FORMING ACTIVE COMPLETED DISSOLVED
created_at	Timestamp of group creation
activated_at	Timestamp when group moved to ACTIVE — null until then
roster_method	AGREED RANDOM BIDDING — how position order is determined
reserve_rate	Percentage of each contribution added to insurance reserve (default: 3%)
grace_period_hours	Hours after due date before a contribution is marked MISSED (default: 48)
recipient_contributes	Boolean. Default TRUE — recipient is required to contribute in their own cycle. Set FALSE to exempt the recipient.

Note on total_cycles Flexibility

total_cycles is set freely by the group at formation — it is not locked to the number of members.

Example A: 6 members, 6 cycles — classic one-rotation gooi-gooi. Each member receives once.

Example B: 6 members, 12 cycles — two full rotations. Each member receives twice per round.

Example C: 6 members, 3 cycles — partial rotation. Roster determines who receives; others receive in a future round.

Recipient assignment across all cycles is determined by the roster at activation — positions repeat if total_cycles > N.

Entity 2: The Member

Each person who joins a group is a member. The Initiator has specific administrative rights to keep the group functioning — they are the group's convenor, not its authority.

Field	Description
member_id	UUID
group_id	Foreign key to Group
user_id	Foreign key to the platform user account
position	Integer — determines payout sequence. If total_cycles > N, position repeats in subsequent rotations.
role	INITIATOR MEMBER TRIGGER_DELEGATE — TRIGGER_DELEGATE is a temporary elevation granted by the Initiator
status	ACTIVE SUSPENDED REMOVED
joined_at	Timestamp of confirmed acceptance

contributed_cycles	Running count of cycles where this member paid in
missed_cycles	Running count of missed contributions
delegate_trigger_to	member_id of the TRIGGER_DELEGATE — null if no delegation active. Set on the Initiator's own member record.
delegation_expires_at	Timestamp when the delegation automatically expires — null if no active delegation. Maximum delegation window: 14 days.

Initiator Rights, Responsibilities, and Delegation

The Initiator is the group convenor. They have the following capabilities:

PRE-ACTIVATION: Create and configure the group; invite members via platform chat; modify contribution amount and settings; dissolve the group if it fails to form.

POST-ACTIVATION: Remove members (with group notification and audit log entry); trigger payout for each cycle once satisfied that contributions are in order; apply or waive default penalties on a case-by-case basis; dissolve the group (unanimous consent required); delegate trigger rights to another member.

What the Initiator **CANNOT** do: receive a larger share of the pot; alter the roster after activation without unanimous consent; override a payout that the system has already processed; access other members' private wallet data; transfer the Initiator role itself (only trigger rights can be delegated).

DELEGATION: The Initiator may designate any active MEMBER as a TRIGGER_DELEGATE. The delegate may trigger payouts only — they inherit no other Initiator rights. Delegation has a maximum duration of 14 days and expires automatically. The Initiator can revoke delegation at any time. Delegation is visible to all group members.

The Initiator is a human safeguard — a check on automated processes — not a financial authority over the group.

Entity 3: The Cycle

A cycle is one complete contribution-and-payout event. A group may have any number of cycles as defined by total_cycles — this is independent of member count.

Field	Description
cycle_id	UUID
group_id	Foreign key to Group
cycle_number	Integer 1..total_cycles
rotation_number	Which rotation this cycle belongs to (cycle_number divided by N, rounded up). Useful when total_cycles > N.
recipient_member_id	The member who receives the payout in this cycle — determined by position and rotation
due_date	Date by which all contributions must be received
status	PENDING COLLECTING AWAITING_TRIGGER PAYOUT_PROCESSING COMPLETE DEFAULTED

total_collected	Running sum of contributions received so far
total_expected	contribution_amount × N (all members contribute, including recipient, by default)
reserve_collected	Sum of reserve amounts collected for this cycle
payout_amount	Actual amount sent to recipient
payout_triggered_by	member_id of Initiator who triggered the payout — audit record
payout_at	Timestamp of successful payout — null until complete

Recipient Contribution Rule — Default Changed in v1.1

DEFAULT (v1.1): The recipient IS required to contribute in their own cycle, like every other member. The pot total therefore equals contribution_amount × N in a full cycle.

The recipient contributes their share into the escrow account and receives the full pot — their contribution flows through the pot like everyone else's.

OPTIONAL: Set recipient_contributes = FALSE at group formation to exempt the recipient. In this case total_expected = contribution_amount × (N-1).

This setting is locked at group creation and cannot change mid-round.

Entity 4: The Contribution

A contribution is a single payment from one member for one cycle.

Field	Description
contribution_id	UUID
cycle_id	Foreign key to Cycle
member_id	Foreign key to Member
amount_base	The standard contribution amount (equals group contribution_amount)
amount_reserve	The reserve top-up (amount_base × reserve_rate)
amount_total	amount_base + amount_reserve — total deducted from member wallet
status	PENDING PAID LATE MISSED
due_date	Copied from parent Cycle
paid_at	Timestamp of payment — null if not yet paid
late_fee	Additional penalty if paid after grace period (default: 0 — applied at Initiator's discretion)

Entity 5: The Payout

A payout is the disbursement of collected funds from the group escrow account to the cycle's designated recipient.

Field	Description
payout_id	UUID
cycle_id	Foreign key to Cycle
recipient_member_id	Foreign key to Member
amount_from_contributions	Sum of base contributions received from escrow
amount_from_reserve	Top-up from reserve fund to cover any shortfall
total_payout_amount	Total amount transferred to recipient
status	PENDING TRIGGERED PROCESSING COMPLETED FAILED
triggered_by	member_id of the Initiator who triggered the payout
triggered_at	Timestamp when Initiator triggered the payout
completed_at	Timestamp of successful delivery — null until complete
shortfall_amount	Amount not covered by contributions (covered by reserve or noted as debt)
defaulter_member_ids	Array of member IDs who missed contributions in this cycle

Group & Cycle Lifecycle

Group States

State	Entered When	Exits When
FORMING	Group created by Initiator	All members confirmed + roster locked → ACTIVE
ACTIVE	All members confirmed, roster locked, start date reached	All total_cycles complete → COMPLETED; or unanimous dissolution → DISSOLVED
COMPLETED	Final cycle payout confirmed	Terminal state — no exit
DISSOLVED	Group failed or disbanded before completion	Terminal state — refund process triggered

Cycle States

State	Entered When	Exits When
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PENDING	Group goes Active; prior cycle completes	Contribution window opens → COLLECTING
COLLECTING	Contribution due date window opens	Grace period closes → AWAITING_TRIGGER
AWAITING_TRIGGER	Grace period closes; Initiator has not yet triggered payout	Initiator triggers payout → PAYOUT_PROCESSING
PAYOUT_PROCESSING	Initiator triggers payout	Transfer confirmed → COMPLETE; transfer fails → retry / FAILED
COMPLETE	Payout successfully delivered to recipient	Terminal — triggers next cycle to PENDING
DEFAULTED	Insufficient funds; reserve cannot cover; or Initiator marks as defaulted	Terminal — group review process triggered

AWAITING_TRIGGER — The Initiator Gate

After the grace period closes, the cycle does not automatically pay out.

It enters AWAITING_TRIGGER, giving the Initiator (or their TRIGGER_DELEGATE) a window to review contribution status, resolve issues with defaulters, and confirm the group is ready.

The Initiator / delegate can: (a) trigger the payout, (b) extend the grace period with group consent, or (c) mark the cycle as DEFAULTED.

If the Initiator is unavailable, they can designate a TRIGGER_DELEGATE — any active member — to act on their behalf for payout triggers only. See Delegation section.

A system-level timeout applies: if neither the Initiator nor any active delegate acts within 72 hours of the grace period closing, the system auto-triggers the payout to protect the recipient.

Initiator Trigger Delegation

The Initiator is the human checkpoint for payout triggers. But they may be unavailable — travelling, ill, or simply unreachable. Rather than forcing the group to wait for the 72-hour auto-trigger, the Initiator can proactively delegate trigger rights to a trusted member.

What Can Be Delegated

Right / Action	Delegatable?	Notes
Trigger payout for a cycle	YES	Core delegation capability — the only right the delegate receives
Apply default penalty	NO	Penalty decisions require Initiator judgement — cannot be delegated
Waive default penalty	NO	Same as above
Remove a member	NO	Membership changes are Initiator-only
Modify group settings	NO	Configuration is Initiator-only

Dissolve the group	NO	Dissolution requires unanimous consent + Initiator action
Re-delegate to another member	NO	The delegate cannot sub-delegate. Only the Initiator can appoint a delegate.
Extend grace period	NO	Grace period extension requires group consent — Initiator coordinates this
Mark cycle as DEFAULTED	NO	Default decisions require Initiator authority

Design Rationale — Why Bounded Delegation?

Delegation solves one specific problem: the Initiator is unavailable and the group should not be held up.

The solution is therefore narrow: give the delegate exactly the capability needed to keep the group moving — payout triggering — and nothing more.

Penalty decisions, membership changes, and dissolution are consequential enough to warrant waiting for the Initiator directly. The 72-hour auto-trigger backstops payout triggering anyway.

Allowing broader delegation would effectively create a second Initiator, which reintroduces the very hierarchy the gooi-gooi model avoids.

Delegation Rules

Rule	Detail
Who can be a delegate	Any ACTIVE member of the group in good standing (not SUSPENDED). The Initiator selects by name from the member list.
Maximum delegation window	14 days. The Initiator sets an expiry date up to 14 days from the delegation date. Cannot be open-ended.
Auto-expiry	System automatically revokes delegation at delegation_expires_at. No manual action required from Initiator.
Revocation	Initiator can revoke delegation at any time before expiry. Takes immediate effect.
Only one delegate at a time	The group may only have one TRIGGER_DELEGATE at any point. Appointing a new delegate automatically revokes the previous one.
Group notification	All members are notified when a delegation is granted, when it is revoked, and when it expires. Delegation is never silent.
Audit log	All delegation grants, payout triggers by delegate, revocations, and expirations are logged with full actor and timestamp.
Delegate accountability	The delegate acts in the Initiator's place. Payout triggers by the delegate are recorded as delegate-triggered, not system-triggered. The same 'safeguard, not authority' principle applies.
Delegate cannot self-appoint	A member cannot request or claim delegation rights. Only the Initiator can grant them.

Recipient cannot be delegate	The member scheduled to receive the payout in the current cycle cannot serve as the delegate for that cycle's payout trigger — conflict of interest.
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Delegation Flow

1	Initiator Delegates	Initiator selects 'Delegate payout trigger' from group settings. Selects a member. Sets expiry date (max 14 days). Confirms with PIN/biometric.
2	Group Notified	All members receive a notification: '[Initiator name] has delegated payout trigger rights to [Delegate name] until [date].'
3	Delegate Notified	Delegate receives specific notification explaining their temporary right: they may trigger payouts only. A help screen explains what this means and what to check before triggering.
4	Cycle Awaiting Trigger	When a cycle enters AWAITING_TRIGGER, both the Initiator and the active delegate (if any) are notified to review and trigger.
5	Delegate Triggers	Delegate reviews contribution status on the dashboard. If satisfied, taps 'Trigger Payout'. System records the trigger as delegate-initiated. Payout proceeds normally.
6	Expiry or Revocation	Delegation expires at delegation_expires_at or when Initiator revokes. All members notified. Delegate's role reverts to MEMBER immediately.

What the Delegate Sees

The delegate's dashboard shows a prominent 'ACTING AS TRIGGER DELEGATE' banner while delegation is active.

For cycles in AWAITING_TRIGGER, the delegate sees the same contribution status view as the Initiator.

The delegate's action button reads 'Trigger Payout' — identical to the Initiator's button. No other Initiator controls are visible to the delegate.

The delegate cannot see penalty controls, member management, or group settings — these remain Initiator-only views.

Process Flows

Flow 1: Group Formation

1	Initiate	Initiator creates group: sets name, contribution amount, cycle frequency, total_cycles, reserve rate, grace period, roster method, and recipient_contributes setting.
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2	Invite	Initiator sends invitations via iMaliChat platform chat message. Each invitation is a rich chat card showing: group name, contribution amount per cycle, cycle frequency, total cycles, and roster method. The invitee taps the card to accept or decline without leaving chat.
3	Accept/Decline	Each invitee explicitly accepts or declines from within the chat. Acceptance is binding. Declining removes them from the invitation list. Initiator can re-invite or invite alternatives.
4	Roster Lock	Once Initiator confirms member list is complete, positions are assigned per roster_method: AGREED (members negotiate order by chat), RANDOM (system lottery — all members see the draw live), BIDDING (members bid for early positions — see Problem 1).
5	Final Confirm	All members see the finalised roster and full contribution schedule across all total_cycles. Each member makes one final explicit confirmation. This is the last exit point before commitment.
6	Activation	On start date (or immediately if all confirmed), group moves to ACTIVE. Cycle 1 opens. This transition is irreversible under normal circumstances.

Quorum Rule

The group cannot activate with fewer than 3 members.

The group can activate with fewer members than originally invited, provided all current members re-confirm the revised roster and schedule.

Unanimous final confirmation is required — not majority. This preserves the gooi-gooi's fully consensual nature.

Flow 2: Contribution Cycle

1	Cycle Opens	System opens contribution window. All members notified (including recipient if recipient_contributes = TRUE): amount due, due date, recipient identity.
2	Reminders	Automated reminders: 3 days before due date, 1 day before, on due date morning. Sent via push notification + SMS for due-date reminder.
3	Payment	Member pays via platform wallet. Contribution status: PENDING → PAID. Funds transferred immediately into group escrow account (the pot). Escrow is the single source of truth for the pot balance.
4	Live Visibility	All members see real-time pot status on the transparency dashboard: who has paid, who has not, live pot total, countdown to grace period. (See Transparency section for full dashboard spec.)
5	Grace Period	Due date passes. Grace period window opens (default 48 hours). Late payments still accepted; contribution status: PENDING → LATE.

6	Grace Closes	Grace period closes. Outstanding contributions marked MISSED. Cycle moves to AWAITING_TRIGGER. Initiator notified to review and act.
7	Initiator Review	Initiator reviews contribution status. Resolves any defaults (see Flow 4). Decides whether to trigger payout, extend grace (with group consent), or mark cycle DEFAULTED.
8	Payout Trigger	Initiator triggers payout. System calculates payout amount (see Flow 3). Funds transferred from escrow to recipient wallet. All members notified with full breakdown.
9	Next Cycle	Cycle moves to COMPLETE. Escrow balance resets for next cycle. Next cycle opens.

Flow 3: Payout Calculation

When the Initiator triggers payout, the system calculates the disbursement amount in this order:

1	Full Pot	All expected contributions received: payout = full escrow balance for this cycle. Reserve untouched.
2	Threshold Check	Contributions received $\geq$ 80% of expected: proceed to payout from collected funds + reserve top-up if needed.
3	Reserve Top-Up	Shortfall = expected minus collected. If group reserve $\geq$ shortfall: draw from reserve. Recipient receives full expected amount. Reserve replenished via defaulter debt (Flow 4).
4	Partial Payout	Reserve insufficient: recipient receives collected amount + available reserve. Remaining shortfall recorded as defaulter debt.
5	Cycle Defaulted	Contributions $<$ 80% of expected AND reserve cannot cover: Initiator marks cycle DEFAULTED. No payout. Group enters review.

Flow 4: Default Handling

When a member misses a contribution, the following process applies. The Initiator decides at each step — the system does not act autonomously on penalties.

1	Flag	Grace period closes with contribution unpaid. System flags the contribution as MISSED and notifies all members — including the defaulter and the Initiator.
2	Initiator Review	Initiator reviews the default. May: (a) apply a penalty, (b) waive the penalty, (c) extend the grace period with group consent, (d) remove the member.
3	Penalty Decision	Initiator applies or waives penalty. If applied: missed amount + any penalty recorded as debt against the defaulting member. Debt is visible to all members.

4	Reserve Cover	System draws from reserve fund to cover the shortfall for the current cycle's payout (if reserve is sufficient). Recipient protected.
5	Suspension	Defaulting member's status moves to SUSPENDED. A SUSPENDED member must repay debt before status lifts.
6	Debt Repayment	In subsequent cycles: SUSPENDED member pays current contribution PLUS debt instalment. Initiator confirms debt repayment before payout trigger.
7	Payout Block	SUSPENDED member cannot receive their own payout until all debt is cleared. If their cycle arrives while suspended, payout is held in escrow until Initiator confirms debt settlement.
8	Removal	Member who defaults in two consecutive cycles, or whose debt remains unresolved by their scheduled payout cycle, is REMOVED by Initiator. Refund of net contributions processed.

Flow 5: Round Completion & Restart

1	Final Cycle	Cycle total_cycles completes. Group status moves to COMPLETED.
2	Round Summary	All members receive full round summary: total contributed, total received, defaults, reserve fund balance, outstanding debts if any.
3	Reserve Return	Remaining reserve fund distributed equally among all members who completed the round without default.
4	Restart Option	Members offered option to start a new round. New round: members may opt out, total_cycles and roster re-agreed.
5	New Round	If all active members confirm: new round begins in FORMING state. Roster re-determined. Each member re-confirms.

Solving the Hard Problems

Problem 1: Position Assignment

Position assignment is the most consequential decision in the gooi-gooi. Early recipients get an interest-free advance; late recipients are effectively savers. All three methods are available at launch:

Method	How It Works	Trade-offs	Best For
AGREED	Members negotiate and agree on order via group chat before activation. Positions assigned by consensus.	Preserves social negotiation. Urgent needs can be accommodated. Requires trust and communication.	Close-knit groups — family, friends, colleagues

RANDOM	System assigns positions by lottery at activation. All members see the draw in real time.	Perceived as fair — no negotiation, no politics. Removes choice entirely.	Groups of acquaintances or mixed-trust situations
BIDDING	Members bid to receive early positions by accepting a discounted payout. Discount distributed to other members as a bonus. Minimum bid is 80% of full pot; bids open for 48 hours.	Introduces price discovery. Rewards patience. The group benefits from urgency premiums. Requires clear UX explanation.	Financially sophisticated groups; larger groups

Bidding Mechanics Detail

Opening price: full pot value (100%). Members bid downward — the lowest acceptable payout wins the earliest position.

Example: 6-member group, pot = R6,000. Member A bids to accept R5,400 (90%) to go first. R600 discount shared equally among the 5 other members (R120 each as a bonus on their future payout).

Minimum bid: 80% of full pot — prevents distressed bidding that makes the position economically irrational.

Bid window: 48 hours. Uncontested positions revert to RANDOM assignment.

Bidding records are visible to all members — fully transparent.

Problem 2: The Custody Question — Platform Escrow

The platform has a full trust accounting ledger and native escrow capability. The gooi-gooi pot is an escrow account created specifically for each group. No external banking partner is required for the pot itself.

Escrow Account Architecture

At group activation, the system creates a dedicated escrow account for the group in the platform trust ledger.

This escrow account IS the pot. It is not a metaphor — it is a real, isolated account with its own balance.

All member contributions debit the member's iMali wallet and credit the group escrow account.

The escrow account is READ-ONLY to all members (they can see the balance, not move funds).

Only the system can credit the escrow account (from member contributions).

Only the system can debit the escrow account — but only when the Initiator has triggered a payout.

The reserve fund is a sub-account of the group escrow account.

When a round completes, the escrow account is closed and any residual balance (returned reserve) is distributed.

Double-entry ledger flows:

Event	Debit	Credit
Member contributes	Member iMali Wallet	Group Escrow Account
Reserve allocation	Group Escrow Account	Group Reserve Sub-Account
Payout triggered	Group Escrow Account	Recipient iMali Wallet
Reserve top-up payout	Group Reserve Sub-Account	Group Escrow Account (then to Recipient)
Reserve returned	Group Reserve Sub-Account	Member iMali Wallets (pro-rata)
Refund on exit	Group Escrow Account	Departing Member iMali Wallet

Problem 3: Partial Cycle Completion

What if only 7 of 10 members contribute before the deadline? The system applies a priority waterfall:

Approach	Rule	Verdict
All-or-Nothing	Payout only when 100% of contributions received	Too strict — one late member can block everyone. Not recommended.
Threshold (80%)	Payout proceeds when 80% of expected contributions received; shortfall recorded as defaulter debt	Practical and fair — keeps the group moving. Fallback when reserve insufficient.
Insurance-Backed	Reserve sub-account covers shortfall — recipient always receives full pot regardless of individual defaults	Best member experience. Default primary approach while reserve is funded.

Recommended Policy

Primary: Insurance-backed payout — reserve covers shortfalls. Recipient receives full pot.
 Fallback: If reserve is insufficient, apply threshold model — recipient receives collected funds + remaining reserve.
 Minimum: If below 80% of expected AND reserve depleted, Initiator reviews and may mark cycle DEFAULTED.
 Reserve rate of 3% per contribution typically builds adequate buffer within 2–3 cycles.

Problem 4: Mid-Round Member Changes

The gooi-gooi is a closed commitment once active. Mid-round changes are handled as follows:

Scenario	Policy
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New member wants to join after ACTIVE	Not permitted. Group is closed once Active. Member must wait for a new round.
Member requests to withdraw before their payout cycle	Permitted — but the group decides the terms. The withdrawing member submits a withdrawal request with reason. The Initiator puts the request to the group. 80% of remaining members must agree. The group collectively decides: (a) full refund with no penalty, (b) partial penalty (group sets the percentage), or (c) full penalty. Decision is final and binding. This preserves the gooi-gooi's community-based nature — there are no fixed rules because circumstances differ.
Member wants to leave after receiving their payout	Not permitted. Having received the pot creates a binding obligation to continue contributing. Outstanding contributions are treated as debt. If the member stops contributing, default handling (Flow 4) applies — potentially escalating to removal and debt recovery.
Member REMOVED due to repeat defaults	System calculates net contributions (total paid minus outstanding debt). Initiator processes refund to departing member. Remaining members re-confirm revised schedule.
Member dies or becomes incapacitated	Treated as a withdrawal request. Group votes unanimously on: (a) refund contributions to the member's estate and continue with the revised roster, or (b) allow a nominated substitute member approved by the group.

Why Group-Decided Withdrawal Penalties?

A fixed penalty (e.g. 15%) cannot account for the range of circumstances that cause someone to need to withdraw.

A member withdrawing due to a family bereavement is different from one withdrawing opportunistically after seeing the market.

The group — who know each other — are in the best position to judge the appropriate response.

The 80% threshold prevents a single dissenting member from blocking a compassionate outcome.

All withdrawal decisions are recorded in the audit log with the group's vote.

Notification System

Notifications are the digital equivalent of the physical meeting reminder. They are the primary mechanism by which social pressure is maintained. Every member always knows exactly what is happening.

Trigger	Recipients	Channel	Priority
Invitation sent by Initiator	Invitee	iMaliChat message (rich card)	High
Contribution window opens	All contributing members	Push + in-app	High
3 days before due date	All unpaid members	Push + in-app	Medium
1 day before due date	All unpaid members	Push + SMS	High

Due date morning	All unpaid members	Push + SMS	High
Member pays	Contributor + all members	Push (all see pot update)	Medium
Pot reaches 50%	All members	Push	Low
Pot reaches 100%	All members	Push	Medium
Grace period opens	All unpaid members	Push + SMS	High
Member missed (grace closes)	All members + Initiator	Push + SMS	High
Cycle awaiting Initiator trigger	Initiator + active delegate (if any)	Push + SMS	High
Initiator triggers payout	All members	Push	Medium
Delegate triggers payout	All members	Push	Medium
Payout delivered	Recipient + all members	Push + SMS	High
Delegation granted	All members + delegate	Push + in-app	Medium
Delegation revoked by Initiator	All members + delegate	Push + in-app	Medium
Delegation expires (auto)	Initiator + delegate	Push	Medium
Delegation expiring in 24 hours	Initiator	Push	Medium
Cycle complete summary	All members	Push + in-app	Medium
Upcoming payout — 2 weeks notice	Next cycle's recipient	Push + in-app	Medium
Withdrawal request submitted	Initiator + all members	Push + in-app	High
Reserve fund low (< 1 cycle cover)	Initiator + all members	Push	Medium
Round complete — restart prompt	All members	Push + in-app	Low
72-hour auto-trigger warning	Initiator	Push + SMS	High

Transparency: The Enforcement Engine

In the physical gooi-gooi, everyone at the table sees everything simultaneously. The digital dashboard must replicate this: one screen, all information, no navigation required. Low cognitive load is not optional — it is the design constraint.

Dashboard Design Constraint

Everything a member needs to know about the current cycle must be visible on a single screen without scrolling.

The member's required action (if any) must be immediately obvious — one prominent button, one clear colour.

Information hierarchy: (1) Do I need to do anything right now? (2) What is the state of the pot? (3) Who has and hasn't paid? (4) When is the deadline? (5) Whose turn is it to receive?
The dashboard is not a report. It is a live status display.

The dashboard is organised into five named zones, all visible on a single screen:

ZONE A — POT METER	Full-width circular/arc progress indicator. Centre shows: current pot total (ZAR) in large type. Arc fills as contributions arrive. Ring segments colour per member (paid = TEAL, unpaid = light grey, grace = GOLD). No label clutter — colour tells the story.
ZONE B — MEMBER CONTRIBUTION GRID	One avatar tile per member arranged in a grid. Each tile: member photo/initials + name + status badge. Status badge colours: PAID (green tick), PENDING (grey clock), LATE (gold exclamation), MISSED (red X), RECIPIENT (teal crown). Tap any tile to see exact amount and timestamp. No list — grid only. All members visible simultaneously.
ZONE C — COUNTDOWN STRIP	Horizontal strip below the grid. Shows: days / hours / minutes until grace period closes. Background shifts: TEAL (> 3 days), GOLD (1–3 days), PINK (< 24 hours), flashing PINK (grace period open). Single number dominates — no ambiguity about urgency.
ZONE D — MY STATUS CARD	Bottom-pinned card. My avatar + contribution status. If unpaid: large PAY NOW button (primary action). If paid: green confirmation + timestamp. If recipient this cycle: 'You receive this cycle' banner with expected payout amount. If suspended: red debt summary + SETTLE DEBT button. One action maximum — no decision fatigue.
ZONE E — ROSTER SCROLL (collapsed by default)	Collapsible strip above Zone D. Shows full cycle roster: cycle number, member name, expected date, payout amount. Current cycle highlighted. Tap to expand — collapses back after 5 seconds of inactivity. Does not dominate the screen when collapsed.

Colour Language — Consistent Across All Zones

TEAL (#1A7F7A) — Paid / confirmed / healthy / recipient

GOLD (#C9960C) — Attention needed / late / grace period / upcoming

PINK/RED (#C0546A) — Missed / suspended / urgent / overdue

DARK GREY — Pending / waiting / neutral

GREEN — Complete / success

No member should need to read a label to know their status — colour communicates everything at a glance.

Accessibility Requirements

All status states must have both a colour AND a symbol (tick, clock, exclamation, X, crown) — colour alone is insufficient for colour-blind users.

Font sizes: pot total minimum 32pt, member names minimum 14pt.

Tap targets: minimum 44×44pt for all interactive elements.
High contrast mode must maintain all colour semantics.

Security Architecture

Authentication

The platform's existing authentication system covers all requirements for the gooi-gooi feature. No additional authentication layer is needed at the gooi-gooi level.

Platform Authentication Coverage

All financially consequential actions (contributions, payout triggers, group activation, withdrawal requests) are already protected by the platform's standard authentication flow.

The gooi-gooi implementation does not need to add its own auth checks — it relies on the platform session and transaction confirmation model.

Confirmation dialogs (explicit tap-to-confirm) are required for: joining a group, triggering a payout, confirming the roster, and submitting a withdrawal request. These are UX confirmations, not re-authentication.

Authorisation Matrix

Action	Initiator	Trigger Delegate	Member	System
Create group	Yes	No	No	No
Invite members via chat (pre-Active)	Yes	No	No	No
Modify contribution amount (pre-Active)	Yes	No	No	No
Modify other settings (pre-Active)	Yes	No	No	No
Dissolve group (pre-Active)	Yes	No	No	No
Accept/decline invitation	N/A	N/A	Yes	No
Confirm roster	Yes	Yes (as member)	Yes	No
Make contribution	Yes	Yes (as member)	Yes	No
View all group data	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Remove a member (post-Active)	Yes	No	No	No

Trigger payout	Yes (manual)	Yes (while active)	No	Timeout fallback only
Apply default penalty	Yes	No	No	No
Waive default penalty	Yes	No	No	No
Grant / revoke delegation	Yes	No	No	No
Vote on withdrawal penalty	Yes (+ vote)	Yes (as member)	Yes (vote)	No
Move cycle state	No	No	No	Yes (automated)
Auto-trigger payout (72hr timeout)	No	No	No	Yes (fallback only)
Auto-expire delegation	No	No	No	Yes (at expiry date)
Dissolve group (post-Active)	Unanimous	Unanimous (as member)	Unanimous	On DEFAULTED cycle

Initiator as Safeguard, Not Authority

The Initiator triggering payouts manually is a safeguard — it gives the group a human checkpoint before funds move.

This is not power over the group. The Initiator cannot redirect the payout, change the recipient, or modify the amount.

The Initiator can only say 'proceed' or 'not yet'. The system executes the payout to the correct recipient at the correct amount.

If the Initiator is unavailable, they can delegate payout trigger rights to any active member for up to 14 days. The delegate inherits only this one capability — nothing else.

The 72-hour auto-trigger prevents the Initiator (or an inactive delegate) from holding the group hostage by inaction.

All Initiator and delegate actions — triggers, penalties, delegations — are logged in the audit trail and visible to all members.

Audit Trail

Every state transition, payment, and decision is logged permanently and immutably. The audit log is the ground truth for all disputes.

Log Field	Description
event_id	UUID
timestamp	ISO 8601 with milliseconds
event_type	Enum: CONTRIBUTION_PAID PAYOUT_TRIGGERED PAYOUT_SENT DEFAULT_FLAGGED PENALTY_APPLIED PENALTY_WAIVED

	WITHDRAWAL_VOTED STATE_CHANGED MEMBER_JOINED MEMBER_REMOVED AUTO_TRIGGER etc.
actor_id	User ID (Initiator or member) or 'SYSTEM' for automated actions
entity_type	GROUP CYCLE CONTRIBUTION PAYOUT MEMBER WITHDRAWAL_REQUEST
entity_id	UUID of the affected entity
before_state	JSON snapshot of entity state before change
after_state	JSON snapshot of entity state after change
metadata	Context: IP, device, vote tallies for group decisions

Fraud Prevention

Attack Vector	Prevention Measure
Sybil attack (one person, multiple member slots)	Identity verification (SA ID number) — one verified identity per group. Platform-level enforcement.
Early recipients collude to stop contributing	Payout block: SUSPENDED members cannot receive until debt cleared. Debt visible to all. Initiator can remove persistent defaulters.
Initiator manipulates roster before activation	Final roster confirmation required from every member independently — not just Initiator.
Initiator withholds payout trigger indefinitely	72-hour auto-trigger: system pays out automatically if Initiator does not act within 72 hours of grace period close.
Fake payment confirmations	Contributions only confirmed on actual escrow account credit — not on payment initiation.
Group created with fake/inactive members	All members must actively accept via chat card — no passive membership. Minimum 3 real acceptances required.
Initiator redirects payout to wrong recipient	System-enforced: payout always goes to the cycle's designated recipient. Initiator can only trigger, not redirect.

Implementation Phases

Phase 1 — MVP Core

The minimum viable gooi-gooi:

- Group creation with AGREED, RANDOM, and BIDDING roster methods
- Member invitation via iMaliChat platform chat message (rich card)
- Group escrow account creation on activation

- Contribution collection into escrow
- Awaiting_TRIGGER state + Initiator payout trigger
- Trigger delegation — Initiator can designate a TRIGGER_DELEGATE (14-day max)
- Single-screen transparency dashboard (all 5 zones)
- Push + SMS notifications for all high-priority events including delegation grants/revocations
- Immutable audit log

Phase 2 — Reliability

Making it robust:

- Insurance reserve sub-account (3% top-up)
- Grace periods and LATE contribution handling
- Default flagging, SUSPENDED status, debt ledger
- Initiator penalty application and waiver
- Partial payout logic with threshold fallback
- Withdrawal request flow with 80% group vote
- Round completion, reserve return, and restart flow
- 72-hour auto-trigger fallback

Phase 3 — Security & Compliance

Production-grade hardening:

- SA ID number identity verification (one identity per group)
- Device fingerprinting for Sybil detection
- POPIA-compliant consent flows and data handling
- Full dispute resolution process backed by audit log
- SARB alignment: escrow account classification and e-money licence confirmation

Phase 4 — Scale

Extended capabilities:

- Multi-group participation (a user in multiple simultaneous groups)
- Group history and trust scoring
- Analytics: cycle health, default rates, reserve adequacy monitoring
- Contribution statements exportable for tax or credit purposes
- total_cycles > N support — multi-rotation rounds

iMaliChat Integration Notes

The gooi-gooi maps cleanly onto existing iMaliChat architecture. The escrow account model in particular requires no new external infrastructure.

Gooi-Gooi Need	iMaliChat Component
Group escrow account (the pot)	Platform trust accounting ledger — new escrow account type, same ledger infrastructure
Reserve sub-account	Sub-ledger of the escrow account — same system
Contribution payments	iMali wallet debit → escrow credit — existing payment flow
Payout transfer	Escrow debit → recipient wallet credit — existing transfer flow
Double-entry ledger	Existing ledger handles all flows natively
Invitation via chat	Rich card message in existing iMaliChat message system
Real-time pot visibility	Firestore real-time listeners — existing pattern
Cycle automation / state management	Cloud Functions scheduled jobs — existing pattern, africa-south1
Initiator payout trigger	New Cloud Function endpoint; Initiator or delegate-authenticated, system-validated
Trigger delegation management	New Firestore document on group member record; delegate_trigger_to + delegation_expires_at fields; scheduled Cloud Function for auto-expiry
72-hour auto-trigger	Scheduled Cloud Function with cycle AWAITING_TRIGGER check
Notifications	Existing FCM push + SMS layer
Group model	Extension of existing iZiko community model
Audit trail	Extension of existing transaction log
Identity verification	Existing FICA-aligned ID verification flow

Cultural Integration

Feature name: GOOI-GOOI — keep it. Vernacular, immediately understood in Cape Flats and township communities.

In isiZulu / isiXhosa contexts, surface the feature under umgalelo (to pour) or mahodisana (to pay back to each other).

The onboarding screen should explain the concept in plain language: 'Every month you all throw in. Each month, one of you gets the whole pot. When everyone has had their turn, the round is done.'

What to Leave Out (Deliberately)

The following are excluded by design. Every item below would move the product away from a gooi-gooi toward a stokvel or a different product entirely.

Intentional Omissions

No chairperson or treasurer role — the Initiator is a convenor; the system is the treasurer
No constitution or rules document — the group settings screen is the agreement
No interest on contributions or payouts — this is savings rotation, not lending
No credit scoring or creditworthiness assessment — trust and social selection are the filters
No group investment options — that is iSivuno, a different product
No post-activation new member joining — the group is closed once active
No platform fees at MVP — monetise via wallet and payment infrastructure, not the gooi-gooi itself
No dispute resolution officer — audit log + Initiator + group transparency are the mechanism
No Initiator financial authority — Initiator triggers and decides, but cannot redirect or intercept funds

*"The great irony of being poor is that you are too poor to save,
but too poor not to save."*

— South African savings literature